FitQuest

Investor Meeting Prep: Expected Questions & Model Answers

Technical • AI • Product • Market & Marketing • Business model • Legal & data • Building leaner, faster and cheaper • UAE vs India build plan

Prepared from the FitQuest prototype as it exists in the repository (React + Vite PWA on the Blink backend, deployed on GitHub Pages): Dashboard, Workout library with an "AI Form Check" concept, GPS Run Tracker, Community feed, Leaderboard and Profile/BMI.

How to use these notes

- Section 1 is the most important: what an investor will notice if they open the app during the meeting. Fix or pre-empt those first.
- Answers are written as **model answers**. Make them yours, and replace every bracketed [number] with your own data.
- Cost and salary figures are **2026 ballpark ranges** for planning. Verify current quotes before you put any of them on a slide.
- Section 13 is a one-page cheat sheet to re-read 10 minutes before you walk in.

Prepared: October 2026. Not legal, tax or financial advice. Confirm regulatory points with a UAE/Indian lawyer or CA before relying on them.

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1. Honest snapshot: what investors will see

Good investors will tap through the demo and ask "is this real?". Below is what the code does today. Know every line of this table so you are never caught off guard. The rule: **call it a prototype, show what is live, label what is a concept.**

Screen	What is real today	What is mock / placeholder	What to say
Dashboard	Layout and navigation	All numbers are hard-coded (42.5 km, 138 bpm, 12,450 kcal, "8 Medals"). Heart rate is shown but nothing measures it.	"Dashboard is a design mock; live stats from your runs ship in the next sprint." Better: wire it to real run data before the meeting.
Run Tracker	Live GPS tracking, route on map, distance (Haversine), timer, pace; saves runs to the database.	Calories = distance x 60 (ignores weight). No GPS noise filtering. On iPhone a PWA stops tracking when the screen locks.	"Core tracking works. Native wrapper fixes background GPS; calories will use weight + MET values."
Workouts	Category filter, session screen	Workout list is fixed in code; "Exercise 1-4" placeholders; no videos.	"Content library is being built; v1 has [N] guided sessions."
AI Form Check	Camera button and UI	No pose model runs. The "Perfect Form" badge and the AI tip are static.	Never demo this as live. Say "concept UI; on-device pose model (MediaPipe/MoveNet) is the next milestone" or build a working squat counter first (1-2 weeks).
Community	Posts saved and listed from the database	Every post uses the same stock photo; author always shows "Fitness Fanatic"; likes/comments/share buttons do nothing.	"Feed MVP; social features are post-PMF."
Leaderboard	UI with tabs and podium	Entirely fake data; names include trademarked characters (Hulk Hogan, Wonder Woman, Speedy Gonzales).	Replace with real users or neutral demo names **before** the meeting. Trademark names look unprofessional to investors.
Profile	Weight/height saved, BMI and category computed	No goals, no history	Fine as is.

Platform facts investors may probe

- Built with **Blink** (AI app builder: hosted auth + database + UI kit). Fast to prototype, but it is a vendor lock-in risk.
- Hosted as a **PWA on GitHub Pages**, installed via Safari "Add to Home Screen". It is not yet in the App Store or Play Store.
- Maps use free OpenStreetMap tiles. OSM's usage policy does not allow heavy commercial traffic, so production needs a tile provider.
- package.json lists ~35 libraries, but several are unused (three.js / react-three-fiber / drei, recharts, dnd-kit, react-hook-form, zod, react-query, framer-motion). Cutting them makes the app smaller and faster (see Section 10).
- No analytics, no tests, no crash reporting yet. You will have no retention data until analytics is added, so add it now.

2. The 12 hardest questions (must-nail)

Q1. Why will anyone use FitQuest instead of Strava, Nike Run Club, HealthifyMe or Cult.fit?

Pick **one** sharp wedge and say it in one sentence. Suggested: *"FitQuest turns fitness into a game with your friends and your city: runs and workouts earn XP, quests and local leaderboards, built for the UAE and India, where the big apps are either Western-centric (Strava/NRC) or diet/coach-heavy (HealthifyMe/Cult)."*

Back it with proof: a beta cohort's retention, a waitlist, a gym or corporate pilot. Without proof, the answer is only an opinion.

Tip: Never say "we have no competitors". Show a 2x2 (Solo vs Social, Tracking vs Game) and place FitQuest in the empty corner.

Q2. What is real in the demo and what is not?

Answer straight away, before they find out: "Run tracking, accounts, profile/BMI and the feed are live. Dashboard stats, the leaderboard and AI form check are design concepts. This is a [X]-week prototype built to validate the experience; here is the roadmap to make each part live."

Tip: Being honest here builds trust. If they find a mock you didn't mention, they will doubt everything else you showed.

Q3. Is the AI real? What is your AI moat?

"Today it's a concept screen. The plan is **on-device pose estimation** (Google MediaPipe Pose Landmarker or TensorFlow MoveNet, both free and run in the browser or on the phone) for rep counting and form cues on 5-10 key exercises. On-device means no video leaves the phone (privacy) and no server GPU cost."

Moat isn't the model (those are open-source). The moat is **labelled form data + coaching rules + engagement loop**, plus the community and local leaderboards (network effects).

Q4. What traction do you have?

Give numbers, even small ones: beta users, weekly active users, D1/D7/D30 retention, runs logged, waitlist size, LOIs from gyms/corporates. If pre-launch: "We launch the beta on [date] with [N] waitlisted users; our 90-day goal is [N] WAU and 25%+ D30 retention."

Tip: If you have zero users, run a 2-week beta with friends, college or a running club before the meeting. 50 real users is worth more than a perfect deck.

Q5. How do you make money?

Freemium subscription (FitQuest Pro: AI form check, advanced plans, challenges) + B2B corporate/campus challenges + sponsored challenges by brands/gyms. Suggested pricing: India INR 99-199/month or INR 799-999/year; UAE AED 19-35/month or AED 149-249/year. B2B: per-employee per-month (e.g. AED 8-15 / INR 40-80).

Q6. Why UAE and India? Isn't that two markets with very different users?

"**UAE = revenue market** (high ARPU, government-backed fitness culture such as the Dubai Fitness Challenge, strong corporate wellness budgets, English-first). **India = scale + build base** (huge smartphone base, low-cost engineering, and a large Indian diaspora in the UAE that links both). Same product, localized pricing and content."

Q7. What does the money get used for, and how long does it last?

Have a single slide: amount, runway in months and 3-4 milestones. Example: "INR [X] / USD [Y] for 18 months: 45% product/engineering (India team), 30% growth (UAE + India), 15% content/coaches, 10% legal/ops. Milestones: native apps live, 25k MAU, 1,500 paying, 2 B2B pilots."

Q8. Why is this team the right one to build it?

Founder-market fit: your own fitness story, technical ability (you shipped this prototype), network in UAE + India gyms/colleges/corporates. Name the gaps honestly and how you'll fill them (advisor, first hire).

Q9. You're on Blink and GitHub Pages: is this scalable?

"Blink let us validate in weeks, not months. The production path is a standard stack: React Native/Expo (or a Capacitor wrapper) + Supabase/Postgres or Firebase, with a clean data layer so migration is contained. Estimated migration: 4-6 weeks for 2 engineers."

Q10. How do you keep users after week 2? (Fitness apps churn fast)

Retention is the core risk in fitness apps, and investors know it. Answer: streaks + weekly quests, friend/team challenges, local leaderboards (city, gym, campus, company), push nudges, and seasonal events (Dubai Fitness Challenge in Oct/Nov, Ramadan-time schedules, Diwali/New-Year challenges). Measure D7/D30 cohorts weekly.

Q11. What happens if Strava/Apple/Google copies this?

"Big players compete globally; we win locally: Arabic + Hindi/regional language, local challenges, partnerships with UAE gyms and Indian colleges/corporates, local pricing and UPI payments. Copying a feature doesn't copy a local community."

Q12. What are the biggest risks and how do you de-risk them?

Retention (game loop + social), CAC (community and B2B-led growth instead of paid ads), platform risk (move off Blink, go native), regulatory (stay "wellness", not "medical"; follow PDPL/DPDP), execution (lean team, 2-week sprints).

3. Product & vision questions

Q13. Describe FitQuest in one sentence.

"FitQuest is a gamified fitness app where every run and workout earns XP and helps you climb leaderboards with your friends, gym and city, with AI coaching on your form."

Q14. Who exactly is your first user?

Be narrow: e.g. "18-30 year-old beginner/intermediate runners and gym-goers in Dubai and [Indian city] who start fitness routines but quit within a month." Avoid "everyone who wants to be fit".

Q15. What is the core loop?

Do activity (run/workout) → earn XP/streak → see rank vs friends → get next quest → share. Every feature should feed this loop; anything that doesn't waits for v2.

Q16. Why gamification? Doesn't it wear off?

Points alone wear off. Social stakes (teams, friends, company vs company) and seasonal events keep it fresh. Cite your own beta data when you have it.

Q17. Do you need a wearable / hardware?

No. The phone does GPS and camera. We **integrate** with Apple Health, Google Health Connect, Garmin and Strava instead of building hardware. Heart rate comes from those sources. (Remove the heart-rate tile until an integration exists.)

Q18. What does v1 contain vs later?

v1: run tracking, guided workouts, XP/streaks, friends leaderboard, Health integrations, payments. v2: AI form check (5 exercises), teams/corporate challenges. v3: community feed, coach marketplace, brand challenges.

Q19. What is your roadmap for the next 6-12 months?

Month 0-3: native app launch + analytics + real leaderboards. Month 3-6: AI rep counter, Pro subscription, first 2 B2B pilots (UAE). Month 6-12: Arabic/Hindi, corporate dashboard, scale India via campuses.

Q20. Why is the BMI-based recommendation credible?

BMI is a rough screening number only. Recommendations will move to goal + history + fitness level based plans; we will not make medical claims.

4. Technical & architecture questions

Q21. What is your tech stack?

Today: React 19 + TypeScript + Vite, Tailwind, TanStack Router, Leaflet maps, Blink SDK (auth + DB), PWA service worker, GitHub Actions deploy to GitHub Pages.

Target: **Expo / React Native** (one codebase for iOS + Android, reuses React/TS skills), **Supabase** (Postgres, auth, storage, row-level security) or Firebase, **MapLibre** + a commercial tile provider, **MediaPipe/MoveNet** on-device, PostHog/Firebase Analytics, Sentry, RevenueCat for subscriptions.

Q22. Why PWA first? Why not native?

Zero app-store friction and fastest to iterate during validation. Limits on iOS: no background GPS when the screen is locked, no HealthKit, limited push. That's why the next step is a native wrapper (Capacitor, ~1-2 weeks) or Expo (~4-8 weeks).

Q23. How accurate is your GPS tracking?

Currently raw GPS with Haversine distance. Production: drop low-accuracy points (accuracy > 20-30 m), speed sanity checks, smoothing (Kalman filter), auto-pause. Background location via native APIs.

Q24. How do you prevent cheating on leaderboards?

Speed caps per activity type (e.g. running > 25 km/h flagged), GPS jump detection, cycling/vehicle detection, device integrity checks, server-side verification of runs, report/review flow, and verified-device badges for top ranks.

Q25. How will it scale to 1M users?

Stateless frontend on a CDN; managed Postgres with indexes on user/time; leaderboards precomputed (materialized views or Redis sorted sets); route data compressed (polyline encoding); images on object storage + CDN. Expected infra cost at 100k MAU: roughly USD 300-1,500/month on managed services.

Q26. Where is the data stored? Is it secure?

Today in Blink's managed cloud. Production: encrypted at rest/in transit, row-level security so users only read their own data, region choice (UAE region for UAE users if required; India region for Indian users).

Q27. Your API keys are in the repo docs. Is that a problem?

The key in DEPLOY.md is a *publishable* (client) key, so it's designed to be public, but the database must have access rules so that key can't read other users' data. Confirm Blink's table permissions before the meeting and move keys out of docs.

Q28. What is your IP? Can anyone copy the code?

The repo is public today. Make it private before fundraising. IP = brand, data, content library, form-check rules/model fine-tuning, community. Assign all IP to the company (founder IP assignment agreement); investors check this in due diligence.

Q29. How fast can you ship?

Show proof: the prototype took [X] weeks. Plan: 2-week sprints, weekly releases via OTA updates (Expo) and the PWA.

Q30. Offline support?

Runs record offline and sync later (local queue). Important in India (patchy data) and outdoor routes.

5. AI questions

Q31. What exactly does the AI do?

Three things, in this order: (1) **rep counting + form cues** from the camera using on-device pose landmarks (knee angle in squats, back angle in push-ups, etc.); (2) **adaptive plans** that adjust difficulty based on completion and pace; (3) **AI coach chat** via an LLM API for motivation and Q&A, with guardrails (no medical advice).

Q32. Isn't this just a wrapper on ChatGPT/Claude?

The form check is on-device computer vision, not an LLM. The LLM is only for the coaching chat. Value is in the game loop, data and local community, not one model.

Q33. What does AI cost per user?

Pose estimation runs on the phone = ~zero server cost. LLM coach: cap messages for free users; use small/cheap models with caching. Target < USD 0.10 per active user per month; Pro users cover the cost.

Q34. How accurate is form check? What about liability?

We validate per exercise against labelled clips (target > 90% rep-count accuracy). Present it as guidance, not medical/physio advice; clear disclaimers; never diagnose injuries.

Q35. Privacy of camera video?

Video is processed on the device and never uploaded. Only numbers (reps, angles, scores) are saved. This is a strong selling point in the UAE and India.

6. Data privacy, health & regulatory (UAE + India)

Topic	UAE	India
Main privacy law	Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021 (PDPL). DIFC and ADGM free zones have their own data protection laws.	Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 + DPDP Rules 2025 (phased rollout through 2026-27).
What it means for us	Clear consent, privacy notice, purpose limits, user rights (access, delete), breach notification, care with cross-border transfers.	Consent notice in plain language, consent manager-ready, verifiable parental consent for under-18s, delete on request, breach reporting to the Data Protection Board.
Health data	Federal Law No. 2 of 2019 (ICT in health fields) requires health data to be stored in the UAE, mainly for healthcare entities. A wellness app generally falls outside it, but get a legal check if you add medical features or partner with clinics/insurers.	No separate health-data law for wellness apps; treat fitness and body data as sensitive anyway. Medical claims could pull the app under CDSCO medical device software rules.
Stay safe by	Positioning as **wellness, not medical**. No diagnosis, no treatment claims.	Same. Plus age gate (18+ or parental consent flow).
Payments	Stripe (UAE), Checkout.com, Telr, Network International; Apple/Google in-app for digital subs.	Razorpay/Cashfree with UPI; Google Play Billing; Apple IAP. RBI e-mandate rules for auto-debit subscriptions.

Q36. Are you compliant with GDPR / PDPL / DPDP?

"We're built privacy-first: minimal data, on-device video, consent screens, delete-my-account, encryption, regional hosting. We'll do a formal privacy review with counsel before public launch." Then actually add a privacy policy + delete-account button.

Q37. Do you collect data from minors?

If you target students, plan for it: India DPDP requires verifiable parental consent for under-18s; UAE PDPL also restricts children's data. Simplest for v1: 18+ only, campus programs for college students.

Q38. Location data is sensitive. How do you protect routes?

Privacy zones (hide start/end near home), private-by-default routes, no public live location. This is a well-known Strava lesson; mention it proactively.

7. Market & competition

Q39. How big is the market?

Use a **bottom-up** estimate; investors trust it more than top-down "USD XX-billion fitness app market" figures. Example:

UAE: [~10M population] x [% active 18-40 smartphone users] x [% who use a fitness app] x [% who pay] x AED 200/year.

India: target top-20 cities, 18-35, fitness-interested: [N million] x [2-4% paid conversion] x INR 800/year.

Plus B2B: [N] companies in UAE with > 200 employees x AED 10/employee/month.

Pull the latest market-size figures from a credible source (e.g. Statista, Redseer, Grand View) and cite the source on the slide.

Competitor	Strength	Gap FitQuest targets
Strava	Global runner/cyclist community, segments	Serious-athlete focus; little gym/workout guidance; not localized
Nike Run Club / Adidas Running	Free, strong brand, audio-guided runs	No real local competition, gamification is light
HealthifyMe (India)	Diet + coach, big Indian user base	Diet-first, not game/social-first

Competitor	Strength	Gap FitQuest targets
Cult.fit (India, also in UAE)	Gyms + classes + app	Bundled with paid gym memberships; app alone is less social
StepSetGo / Sweatcoin	Steps-to-rewards gamification	Steps only; no workouts or form coaching
Fitbod / Freeletics	AI workout plans	Expensive, Western pricing, solo experience
Apple Fitness+ / Google-Fitbit	Device ecosystems	Locked to devices; global, not local
UAE gyms & access passes (GymNation, Fitness First, Privilee, etc.)	Physical access	Possible **partners**, not competitors

Q40. Why now?

Post-pandemic home fitness habits, government programs (Dubai Fitness Challenge, Fit India Movement, UAE/Saudi wellness agendas), cheap on-device AI now able to do pose tracking in a browser, and rising corporate wellness budgets.

Q41. What is your unfair advantage?

Pick 1-2 you can prove: founders' community access (clubs, colleges, gyms), local language/culture, low build cost (India team), or proprietary partnerships.

8. Marketing & growth (UAE + India)

Q42. How will you acquire your first 10,000 users?

Community-led, not ad-led:

UAE: run clubs (Dubai/Abu Dhabi weekend run clubs), gym partnerships with QR-code onboarding, a FitQuest challenge during the **Dubai Fitness Challenge (Oct-Nov)**, university campuses (e.g. Dubai Knowledge Park / Academic City), corporate step/run challenges, fitness micro-influencers on Instagram/TikTok.

India: college fests and campus ambassador program, inter-college leaderboards, Instagram Reels + YouTube Shorts creators (Hindi + regional), marathons (city marathons), apartment/RWA challenges, corporate HR in Bengaluru/Hyderabad/Pune/Kochi tech parks.

Both: built-in referral ("bring a friend = 2x XP week"), shareable run cards for Instagram Stories.

Q43. What is your CAC?

Give current or target figures, and the channel mix. Benchmarks vary a lot. As a planning assumption: paid installs in India are much cheaper than in the UAE, but convert to paid less. Target blended CAC payback < 6-9 months. Show LTV:CAC goal ≥ 3:1.

Q44. What is your go-to-market order?

Recommended: launch beta in **one** city per country (e.g. Dubai + Bengaluru or Kochi). Win density first (leaderboards need nearby users), then expand.

Q45. Brand positioning?

"Fitness that feels like a game." Youthful, competitive, inclusive (beginners welcome). Keep the lime/purple identity consistent across app, Instagram and merch.

Q46. Localization?

UAE: English + Arabic (RTL layout), Ramadan-friendly schedules (post-Iftar workouts), summer indoor workouts (heat), women-only challenges/privacy options. India: English + Hindi first, regional languages later, UPI pricing, low-data mode.

Q47. B2B: who buys and why?

UAE corporate HR / wellness teams (employee engagement, insurer wellness incentives), schools/universities, gyms (member retention). India: IT/GCC companies' HR, colleges. Sell a team challenge dashboard + monthly reports.

Q48. What metrics do you track?

Activation (first run in 24 h), D1/D7/D30 retention, WAU/MAU, workouts per user per week, streak length, K-factor (referral), free-to-paid conversion, churn, CAC, LTV, B2B pilot-to-paid conversion.

9. Business model & unit economics

Revenue stream	UAE (suggested)	India (suggested)	When
Pro subscription	AED 19-35/mo or AED 149-249/yr	INR 99-199/mo or INR 799-999/yr	Month 3-6
Corporate/campus challenges	AED 8-15 per employee/month, min. 100 seats	INR 40-80 per employee/month	Month 4-9
Sponsored challenges	Sports brands, gyms, F&B (AED 10k-50k per campaign)	Brands, D2C nutrition (INR 1-5 lakh/campaign)	Month 6+
Partner commissions	Gym trials/passes, events	Gym trials, marathon registrations	Month 6+

Q49. Walk me through your unit economics.

Use this structure and fill in your numbers:

ARPPU (after app-store fee 15% under Apple/Google small-business programs + payment gateway 2-3%) → gross margin (infra + AI ~5-10% of revenue) → monthly churn → LTV = ARPPU x gross margin / churn → compare to CAC.

Example (illustrative): UAE Pro at AED 25/mo → ~AED 21 net → 85% margin → 8% monthly churn → LTV ≈ AED 223. Paid CAC must stay under ~AED 75 for a 3:1 ratio.

Q50. Why will people pay when Nike Run Club is free?

They pay for what free apps don't give: AI form coaching, structured quests/plans, team/corporate challenges, and prizes. Keep tracking free forever; charge for coaching and competition.

Q51. When do you break even?

Give a scenario: e.g. "With an India-based team of 5 (~USD 12-18k/month burn), break-even at roughly [N] Pro subscribers or [N] B2B seats." Show the math on one slide.

10. Building leaner: cutting parts, faster and cheaper

Investors love founders who spend carefully. "Parts" here means features, libraries, services and people. Fewer of each means faster shipping, lower cost and fewer bugs.

10.1 Cut features: one core loop for v1

Keep in v1	Defer to v2+	Why
Run tracking (GPS)	Community feed with photos	Feeds need moderation, storage and content safety. Use "share to Instagram/WhatsApp" instead (free distribution).
5-10 guided workouts (video/animation)	Big workout library	Quality over quantity; license or partner with coaches instead of filming 100s.
XP, streaks, friends + city leaderboard	Global leaderboards, badges zoo	Small, local leaderboards feel winnable.
Apple Health / Health Connect sync	Own heart-rate / wearable features	Use phone/watch data instead of building it.
Rep counter for 2-3 exercises (squat, push-up, jumping jack)	Full AI form check for all exercises	Proves AI cheaply; expand once it works.
Pro paywall (RevenueCat)	Marketplace, coach booking	Revenue proof early.

10.2 Cut code dependencies (already in the repo)

- Remove unused libraries: **three.js, @react-three/fiber, @react-three/drei** (3D, unused), **recharts**, **@dnd-kit**, **react-hook-form + zod + @hookform/resolvers**, **@tanstack/react-query**, **framer-motion**, **glob**; move **stylelint** to devDependencies. Expected result: smaller install, faster builds, faster first load on Indian 4G.
- Replace Leaflet + public OSM tiles with **MapLibre** + a tile provider free tier (MapTiler, Stadia, or Protomaps self-hosted on object storage, which costs almost nothing).
- Turn hard-coded workout/leaderboard arrays into database tables so content updates don't need a new app release.
- Add only 3 "must-have" services: analytics (PostHog free tier), crash reporting (Sentry free tier), subscriptions (RevenueCat free until meaningful revenue).

10.3 Build stack: fastest + cheapest path

Option	Time to stores	Cost	Verdict
Keep PWA + wrap with **Capacitor**	1-3 weeks	Lowest; reuse all code	Best for the next 30 days: gets you into App Store/Play Store and background GPS fast
Rebuild in **Expo / React Native**	6-10 weeks	Medium; same React/TS skills	Best long-term mobile experience (HealthKit, sensors, OTA updates)
Flutter	8-12 weeks	Medium; new language (Dart)	Good, but throws away existing React code
Separate native iOS + Android	4-6 months	2x team	Avoid at this stage

- Backend: stay on Blink until ~1,000 users for speed; plan a migration to **Supabase** (free tier, then ~USD 25/month Pro) or Firebase. Keep all Blink calls behind one data module so the switch is quick.
- Use AI coding tools (Claude Code etc.) + a UI kit (shadcn/ui, already used) to keep the team at 2-3 engineers.
- Content: license exercise animations or partner with UAE/Indian trainers for revenue share instead of paying for studio shoots.

- Fixed one-time store costs: Apple Developer USD 99/year, Google Play USD 25 one-time.

10.4 Lean monthly running cost (first 6-12 months, estimate)

Item	Estimate (USD/month)
Hosting + database (Supabase/Firebase + CDN)	0-50 early, 150-600 at ~50-100k MAU
Maps tiles	0-100 (free tiers / self-hosted)
AI (on-device pose = free; LLM coach with caps)	20-300
Analytics, crash, email, push	0-100 (free tiers)
Design/tools (Figma, Workspace, domain)	50-150
Total tech running cost	**~USD 100-1,000/month** before scale

11. UAE vs India: where and how to build

Recommended model (likely question: "where is your team?"): **UAE holding/commercial entity for customers, partnerships and fundraising + India engineering team** (own subsidiary or contractors). This gives UAE credibility and ARPU with India-level build costs.

11.1 Team cost comparison (2026 ballpark, per month, full-time)

Role	India (INR / month)	India (~USD)	UAE (AED / month)	UAE (~USD)
Junior full-stack / mobile dev (0-2 yrs)	40k-80k	500-1,000	8k-14k	2,200-3,800
Mid React/React Native dev (3-5 yrs)	1-1.8 lakh	1,200-2,200	15k-25k	4,100-6,800
Senior / lead engineer	2-4 lakh	2,400-4,800	25k-40k	6,800-10,900
UI/UX designer	60k-1.5 lakh	700-1,800	12k-22k	3,300-6,000
Growth / community marketer	40k-1 lakh	500-1,200	10k-20k	2,700-5,400
Freelancer / agency hourly	USD 15-40/hr		USD 40-120/hr	

UAE salaries usually also include visa, medical insurance and end-of-service gratuity; budget about 15-25% on top. Figures are ranges; check current offers on LinkedIn/Naukri/Bayt.

11.2 Lean team plan for the first 12 months

Setup	Team	Approx. monthly burn	Notes
Recommended hybrid	Founders in UAE (sales, partnerships) + 2 devs + 1 designer (part-time) in India	USD 5k-9k	Fast and cheap; UAE face for customers/investors
All India	Founders + 3 devs + 1 marketer in India	USD 4k-8k	Cheapest; weaker UAE market presence
All UAE	Founders + 3 devs + 1 marketer in UAE	USD 18k-30k	~3x cost; only if investors require local team

11.3 Company setup

Item	UAE	India
Entity	Free-zone LLC/FZCO (e.g. IFZA, Meydan, RAKEZ, SHAMS; or DMCC, Dubai Silicon Oasis; Hub71 in Abu Dhabi for funded tech startups)	Private Limited Company (MCA SPICe+), DPIIT Startup India recognition
Typical setup cost	Roughly AED 12k-25k/year for licence + 1 visa in budget free zones; more in premium zones	~INR 10k-25k to incorporate; INR 50k-1.5 lakh/yr for CA + compliance
Tax	Corporate tax 9% on profit above AED 375k; qualifying free-zone income may get 0%. VAT 5% on subscriptions to UAE users.	Corporate tax ~25% (22% + surcharge option); DPIIT startups can apply for 3-year tax holiday (Sec. 80-IAC). "Angel tax" abolished from FY 2025-26. GST 18% on digital services.
Support programs	Hub71, in5 (Dubai), Dubai Future Foundation programs, Sheraa (Sharjah), Dubai SME	Startup India Seed Fund Scheme (via incubators), state startup missions (e.g. Kerala Startup Mission, Karnataka Elevate), university incubators
Investor angle	Gateway to GCC capital and Saudi expansion	Large angel/VC ecosystem; cheaper to reach scale

Q52. Why not just build everything in India?

"We do build in India. The UAE entity is where our first paying customers, corporate pilots and GCC investors are, and it gives a clear path to Saudi Arabia and the wider GCC."

Q53. How do you manage a cross-border team?

Overlapping hours (UAE is 1.5 hours behind India), weekly demos, one shared backlog, written specs. Transfer pricing/intercompany service agreement between UAE parent and India subsidiary (needs a CA).

Q54. Can you get to the UAE market without a UAE office?

Yes for B2C via app stores, but B2B contracts, local payments and government partnerships (e.g. fitness challenges) are much easier with a UAE trade licence.

12. Team, funding, valuation & use of funds

Q55. How much are you raising and at what valuation?

Give a clear number and instrument: e.g. "USD [150-500k] pre-seed on a SAFE / iSAFE (India) / convertible note with a [USD X M] cap." Pre-revenue valuations depend heavily on team and traction; anchor on comparable local pre-seed rounds and stay flexible.

Q56. What milestones will this round hit?

Native apps live, [N] MAU, [N]% D30 retention, [N] paying users, [N] B2B pilots, AI rep counter shipped. These milestones should set up the seed round.

Q57. Who else is investing? Have you applied to accelerators?

Mention any angels, family & friends, accelerators (Hub71, in5, Startup India programs, Y Combinator, Antler, etc.) you have applied to.

Q58. How much equity do founders hold? Vesting?

Clean cap table: founders hold most of the equity, 4-year vesting with 1-year cliff, ESOP pool of 10-15% planned. Investors check this in due diligence.

Q59. What if you don't raise?

"We continue lean: the PWA + India team costs ~USD [X]/month and we focus on B2B pilots for revenue." This shows resilience.

Q60. What's your exit path?

Acquisition by a fitness/health platform (gym chains, Cult.fit-type players, insurers' wellness arms, sportswear brands) or growth to a regional leader in GCC + India.

Q61. Why are you the right founder? What will you do full-time?

Be clear on commitment (full-time vs studying/working). Investors will ask directly.

Questions YOU should ask the investor

- What does your typical involvement look like after investing?
- Have you invested in consumer health/fitness before? What did you learn?
- Can you help with UAE corporate/gym partnerships or Indian campus distribution?
- What milestones would you want to see before the next round?
- What is your decision process and timeline?

13. One-page cheat sheet

Say these 6 things clearly

- **One-liner:** FitQuest makes fitness feel like a game: every run and workout earns XP and ranks you against friends, your gym and your city, with on-device AI coaching.
- **Wedge:** social + game-first, localized for UAE + India; big apps are either serious-athlete or diet-first.
- **Model:** free tracking, Pro subscription for AI coaching + challenges, B2B corporate/campus challenges.
- **Build:** UAE front office + India engineering; lean stack; ~USD 5-9k/month burn.
- **Honesty:** live = run tracking, accounts, profile, feed. Concept = dashboard stats, leaderboard, AI form check.
- **Ask:** USD [X] for [18] months to reach [milestones].

Fix before the meeting (priority order)

#	Fix	Effort
1	Replace fake leaderboard names (Hulk Hogan, Wonder Woman, Speedy Gonzales) with real beta users or neutral names; ideally compute from real runs	2-4 hours
2	Make Dashboard show real totals from saved runs; remove the heart-rate tile	Half a day
3	Label AI Form Check as "Coming soon", or build a basic MediaPipe squat counter	1 hour / 1-2 weeks
4	Community: show real author names and allow real photo upload, or hide photos	Half a day
5	Calories from weight x MET x time; filter bad GPS points	Half a day
6	Make the GitHub repo private; check database access rules; add privacy policy + delete-account	1 day
7	Add analytics (PostHog) and start a 2-week beta to get retention numbers	1 day + 2 weeks
8	Remove unused libraries; rename package from "vite-react-app" to "fitquest"	1-2 hours
9	Capacitor wrap so you can say "in TestFlight / Play internal testing"	1-2 weeks
10	Prepare 3 numbers to quote from memory: users, retention, burn/runway	-

Red-flag phrases to avoid

- "We have no competition."
- "Our AI is fully working" (when it's a mock).
- "If we get just 1% of India..." (top-down only).
- "We'll go viral" with no channel plan.
- Unclear answers about who is full-time and who owns the IP.

Ballpark figures (salaries, setup costs, pricing, infra) are planning estimates as of Oct 2026 and must be verified. Regulatory summaries are general information, not legal advice.